

Seattle

The best of the best in the city — must-visit, unique, a rockstar in its own right. The first edition, and the last of the eight.

2

James Beard 2026 finalists — Atoma and Surrell

13

James Beard 2026 semifinalists

1950

Canlis — the room, the valet, the view

738

places across twelve lists

Honor Roll 10

Cafés 53

Speakeasies 50

Rooftops 50

Bars 114

Coffee 50

Restaurants 121

Brunch 50

Off-beat 50

Bakeries 50

Dessert 50

Scene 50

Nightlife 50

Itineraries 1 · 3 · 5 days

Yellow

= you've been

★

Michelin star

Bib

Bib Gourmand

50 Best №1 bar ranking

JB F 2026

James Beard finalist or semifinalist

RoY Seattle Met Restaurant of the Year

closed

verify = check before you go

Resy

Tock

OpenTable

SevenRooms

where to book

Amex ✓

Resy/Tock credit applies (Platinum \$100/qtr, Gold \$50 twice a year)

JB F 2026

James Beard nominee

\$-\$\$\$\$

rough spend per person: under \$20 / \$20–60 / \$60–150 / \$150+

Romantic

Date night

Casual

occasion (editorial, by category and price)

Compiled by Tony Abraham against Yelp, Google, The Seattle Times, Seattle Met, Eater Seattle, OpenTable, Resy and Tock. Michelin does not cover Seattle; the James Beard

Foundation's 2026 awards are the cross-check. Cover: the Space Needle at dusk, via Pexels.

Tony *Abraham*

Technology entrepreneur. New Yorker. A passionate home cook who learned that the best way to understand a dish is to try to recreate it the next morning.

Honestly Speaking is written from a simple conviction: that the food itself — its taste, its texture, its quiet decisions — deserves a more careful kind of attention than it usually gets. The plate, not the room. The dish, not the hype.

Based in New York, with field notes from all around. *listede ville* / *Seattle* is the eighth and last city guide of the first series — a city Michelin has never rated, which makes the Beard lists, the oyster farms and the coffee lineage the map.

First edition, Fall/Winter 2026. The eight-city series is complete.

Honestly Speaking is also a restaurant review site — independent, unsponsored, one dish at a time. The city guides tell you where; the reviews tell you what to order and why. Read them at honestlyspeaking.xyz.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listede ville.com.



Honor Roll • 10 plates

Don't leave without these.

Ten places, ranked by nothing but the plate. A drive-in from 1954, a Filipino counter in the market with a Beard medal, an oyster bar on Ballard Avenue and the tasting rooms the Beard committee keeps nominating, all held to the same question: is this the best version of the thing in the city?

Michelin hasn't reached Seattle, so the marks here are the Beard Foundation's and the city's own. These ten are where the critics, the awards and thousands of Google reviews all point the same way — and where the food, not the view, is the reason. Room, scene and price didn't count.

How to read it The marks are the same as everywhere else in the guide. The two lines under each name are new: why it made the roll, and what to put in front of you when you get there.

Canlis

01

Queen Anne; the view since 1950

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Canlis family's midcentury room above Lake Union has been the city's special-occasion table for seventy-five years, and the kitchen has never coasted on the glass wall: a tight tasting menu of Northwest seafood and produce that changes with the season and a service culture the rest of the country studies.

Order The tasting, with the wine pairing. If the Canlis salad is offered as a supplement — the 1950 original, tossed tableside — say yes.

Atoma

02

Wallingford; Johnny Courtney

JBFF 2026 finalist RoY 2024 \$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Late night Group

Johnny Courtney's Wallingford room is the restaurant Seattle's critics argue about least: Restaurant of the Year in 2024, a Beard finalist in 2026, and a menu of shared plates that reads Northwest but eats like nowhere else. The rosette cookies alone have a following.

Order The rosette cookies (caramelized onion and local cheese), the Hokkaido scallop, the crumpets, and the maitake plate; the baked Alaska to finish. Order for the table.

Sushi Kashiba

Pike Place; Shiro Kashiba

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

Shiro Kashiba brought Edomae sushi to Seattle in 1970, and at eighty-plus he still works the counter several nights a week, cutting Northwest fish — geoduck, spot prawn, king salmon — the way Tokyo taught him. The one omakase in the city that is also a piece of its history.

Order Omakase at the counter, and ask which nights Shiro-san is behind it. Local fish over flown-in: the geoduck, the spot prawns, the salmon.

03

Musang

Beacon Hill; Melissa Miranda

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Melissa Miranda's Beacon Hill house cooks Filipino food the way the city's Filipino families do, then sharpens it: kinilaw, ribs, corn cakes, a fried chicken that should be famous. A Beard semifinalist every year and the warmest room on this roll.

Order The fried chicken, the corn cakes, the kinilaw and the pancit — four plates for four people is the house rule. Chocolate mousse to finish.

06

Spinasse

Capitol Hill; tajarin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Piedmontese cooking on Capitol Hill for nearly twenty years, built on one plate: tajarin, forty-egg-yolk noodles cut by hand every afternoon and dressed with butter and sage or a slow ragù. Nothing on the menu is trendy and nothing needs to be.

Order The tajarin al ragù, the vitello tonnato, and the agnolotti if they're on. Sit at the bar to watch the pasta being cut.

04

Pho Bac Súp Shop

Chinatown-ID / Rainier; the Pham sisters, JBF

Outstanding Restaurateur finalists

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

The Pham sisters took their parents' 1982 pho shop — the boat-shaped original still stands a block away — and made it the city's essential bowl: a broth cooked all day, brisket cut thick, and a fried chicken wing on the side that regulars won't skip. Beard finalists for how they run it.

Order Pho tái nạm, a large, with a side of the fried chicken wings; the bún bò Huế if you want heat. Cash is cheaper.

07

The Walrus and the Carpenter

Ballard; Renee Erickson

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Renee Erickson's oyster bar at the back of a Ballard Avenue alley is where Seattle's whole oyster culture points: a dozen Washington varieties on ice, small plates that change nightly, no reservations for years and a line worth standing in. Happy hour is the local move.

Order A dozen oysters, picked across the board; the Hama Hama clams, the scallop crudo, the fried oysters, and the bread. Go at four.

05

Oriental Mart

Pike Place; the Filipino counter, JBF America's

Classic 2020

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

A Filipino grocery counter inside the market, run by the same family since 1971 and honored with a Beard America's Classic: adobo, sinigang and longanisa ladled into takeout boxes, with rules of service everyone learns the first time. Come early; the sinigang sells out.

Order Salmon sinigang, pork adobo and a longanisa on the side, with rice and pancit. Know your order before you reach the counter.

08

Un Bien

09

Ballard; the Paseo family's original

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Group

The Caribbean roast — slow-cooked pork shoulder, caramelized onions, aioli and cilantro on a toasted roll — is Seattle's sandwich, and this is the original family's counter. Paseo, which kept the name, is the argument; Un Bien is the answer.

Order The Caribbean Roast, with everything, and a side of the grilled corn on the cob. Napkins.

Dick's Drive-In

10

Wallingford / multiple; since 1954

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Group

Cash, walk-up windows, no substitutions, open until two, and a burger that hasn't changed since 1954.

Ten thousand Google reviews land at 4.6 for a reason: the Deluxe is small, cheap and exactly right at one in the morning.

Order A Deluxe, hand-cut fries and a chocolate shake. Eat on the hood of the car, like the last seventy years of Seattle.



Cafés · 53 places

Cafés & all-day / chef's neighborhood spots

Beacon Hill's Beard row, Renee Erickson's rooms, and the Capitol Hill counters that run the city.

Seattle's neighborhood rooms are the city's best: Atoma, Little Beast, Musang and Homer — four of the Beard semifinalists — plus Renee Erickson's Walrus, Whale Wins and Bateau, and the Capitol Hill counters.

Why these Picked for the room you'd return to on a weeknight. Nine of Seattle's fifteen 2026 James Beard semifinalists are on this list; Atoma is the finalist and Seattle Met's 2024 Restaurant of the Year.

Atoma

Wallingford; Johnny Courtney

JBF 2026 finalist RoY 2024 \$\$\$

Tock Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Little Beast Ballard

JBF 2026 semifinalist RoY 2025 \$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Wayland Mill

Northlake

JBF 2026 semifinalist new \$\$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Café Suliman

Melrose Market; Ahmed Suliman

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Musang

Beacon Hill; Melissa Miranda

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Homer

Beacon Hill; Logan Cox

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Pancita

Ravenna; Janet Becerra

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Ramie

Capitol Hill; Vietnamese

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Le Caviste

Belltown; French wine bar

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Walrus and the Carpenter

Ballard; Renee Erickson

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Whale Wins

Fremont

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bar Melusine

closed

Bateau

Capitol Hill; the whole-animal steakhouse

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Westward

Lake Union; the fire pit

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Sitka & Spruce

closed

Spinasse

Capitol Hill; tajarin

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Artusi

Capitol Hill; Spinasse's bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tavolàta

Belltown / Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

How to Cook a Wolf

Queen Anne / Madison Park

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Marmite

Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

L'Oursin

Central District; natural wine + seafood

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

JuneBaby

Ravenna; Edouardo Jordan

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Salare

closed

Off Alley

Columbia City; 8 seats

\$\$\$\$ [Tock](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Lark

Capitol Hill; Johnathan Sundstrom

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Altura

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Cafe Juanita

Kirkland; the drive

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Copine

Ballard

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Barnacle

Ballard; Erickson's aperitivo bar

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Rupee Bar

Ballard; Sri Lankan-Indian

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Stoneburner

Ballard

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Sawyer

Ballard

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Un Bien

Ballard; Caribbean roast pork sandwiches

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Bar del Corso

Beacon Hill; pizza

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Delancey

Ballard; pizza

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Essex

Ballard; Delancey's bar

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Vif

Fremont; wine + coffee

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Manolin

Fremont; the fire

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Rock Creek

Fremont; seafood

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Eight Row

Green Lake

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Frelard Tamales

Ballard

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Nue

Capitol Hill; global street food

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Oddfellows Café

Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Bar Ferdinand

Chophouse Row; wine

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Taylor Shellfish Oyster Bar

Capitol Hill / Pioneer Square / Queen Anne

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Damn the Weather

Pioneer Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

H-Corvo

closed

The London Plane

closed

Ben Paris

Pioneer Square; State Hotel

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Le Pichet

Pike Place; since 2000

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Café Campagne

Pike Place

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Casual](#)

Matt's in the Market

Pike Place

\$\$ [Amex ✓](#)

Sushi Kashiba

Pike Place; Shiro Kashiba

\$\$\$\$ [Amex ✓](#)



Speakeasies · 50 places

Speakeasies & hidden bars

Through a diner, behind a doorbell, into a tiki submarine. Ranked, loosely, by the drink.

Seattle hides its bars behind a diner (Roxy's), a doorbell (Knee High), an alley door (Bathtub Gin) and inside a tiki submarine (Inside Passage). Canon has more bottles than any bar in the hemisphere.

Why these Ranked by the drink. Roquette and Rob Roy are the 2026 Beard semifinalists; Zig Zag is where Murray Stenson made the Last Word famous again. The closed ones are listed so you know what the scene lost.

Roquette

Belltown

JBF 2026 semifinalist, Outstanding Bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Rob Roy

Belltown; Anu Apte

JBF 2026 semifinalist, Cocktail Service

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Canon

Capitol Hill; the largest spirits collection in the Western Hemisphere

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bathtub Gin & Co

Belltown; the alley door

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Needle & Thread

above Tavern Law, Capitol Hill; the phone

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Tavern Law

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Zig Zag Café

Pike Place; the Hillclimb

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Knee High Stocking Co

Capitol Hill; the doorbell

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Foreign National

Capitol Hill; behind Stateside

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Backdoor at Roxy's

Fremont; through the diner

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Hazlewood

Ballard; tiny

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Sun Liquor

Capitol Hill; distillery bar

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Rumba

Capitol Hill; 500 rums

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Inside Passage

Belltown; the tiki submarine

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Navy Strength

Belltown; tiki

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

No Anchor

Belltown; beer + cocktails

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Deep Dive

South Lake Union; beneath the Spheres

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Deep Dive

South Lake Union

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Cotto?

closed ; use Herb & Bitter (Capitol Hill; amaro)

The Doctor's Office

Capitol Hill; 8 seats, by reservation

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Life on Mars

Capitol Hill; records + vegan

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Vito's

First Hill; the lounge

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Pine Box

Capitol Hill; the former funeral home

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Vacilando

Capitol Hill; Mexican cocktails

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

ShibShib

Chinatown—International District; Café Suliman's bar

new \$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Tomo's bar

White Center

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Ferdinand

Chophouse Row

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Le Caviste

Belltown

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Damn the Weather

Pioneer Square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Good Bar

Pioneer Square

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Central Saloon

Pioneer Square; since 1892

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

J&M Café

Pioneer Square; since 1889

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Merchant's Café

Pioneer Square; oldest in the city

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Ben Paris

State Hotel

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Pennyroyal

Hotel Sorrento

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Fireside Room

Sorrento; the library

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bookstore Bar

Alexis Hotel

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Linda's Tavern

Capitol Hill

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Comet

Capitol Hill

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Unicorn / Narwhal

Capitol Hill; the carnival

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cha Cha Lounge

Capitol Hill; basement

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Shorty's

Belltown; pinball + hot dogs

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Crocodile's Here-After

Belltown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Hattie's Hat

Ballard

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

King's Hardware

Ballard

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Al's Tavern

Wallingford

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Blue Moon Tavern

University District; since 1934

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Whisky Bar

Belltown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar House

Fremont; the tiny one

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

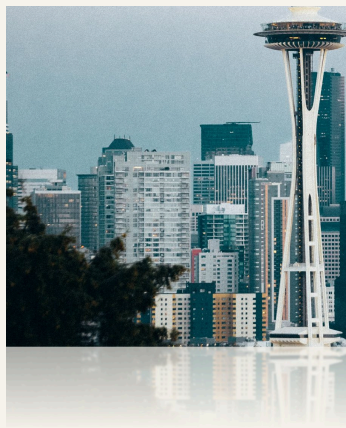
[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Radiator Whiskey

Pike Place; upstairs

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)



Rooftops · 50 places

Rooftop bars

The Needle, the Sound, Lake Union — and the beer gardens and piers that do the same job at water level.

A city of water more than roofs: the Nest over Pike Place and the Sound, Mbar's Needle view, Westward's fire pit on Lake Union — and the beer gardens and piers that do the same job.

Why these Chosen for the view first, stretched to include the waterfront decks and the breweries' gardens. Kerry Park with a DeLaurenti picnic is on because it's the view, and it's free.

The Nest

Thompson Seattle; Pike Place and the Sound

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Mbar

South Lake Union; the Space Needle view

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Frolik

Motif Seattle; the deck

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Fog Room

Charter Hotel

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

SkyCity?

closed (Loupe Lounge, Space Needle)

Loupe Lounge

Space Needle; the rotating floor

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Westward

Lake Union; the beach

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Little Water Cantina

Eastlake; Lake Union

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Marination Ma Kai

West Seattle; the ferry view

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Salty's on Alki

West Seattle; the skyline

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Alki Beach's Cactus

West Seattle

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Ray's Boathouse

Shilshole; the Sound

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Ballard's Barnacle patio

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Little Coyote?

closed ; use Fremont Brewing's beer garden (the urban beer garden)

Fremont Brewing

Fremont

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Stoup Brewing

Ballard

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Reuben's Brews

Ballard; the taproom

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Lucky Envelope

Ballard

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Obec

Ballard

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Holy Mountain

Interbay; the wild ales

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Cloudburst

Belltown / Shilshole

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Optimism Brewing

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Chuck's Hop Shop

Central District / Greenwood

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Machine House Brewery

Georgetown; English ales

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Georgetown Brewing

the Manny's

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Jules Maes Saloon

Georgetown; since 1888

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Pine Box

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Rhein Haus

Capitol Hill; bocce beer hall

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Bar Harbor

South Lake Union; the marina

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Daniel's Broiler

Lake Union; the marina view

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Chinook's

Fishermen's Terminal

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Pike Place's Maximilien

the Sound from the market

\$\$\$

Date night Group

The Pink Door

Pike Place; the deck, the trapeze

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Cutters Crabhouse

Pike Place; the deck

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Ivar's Acres of Clams

Pier 54; the deck, since 1938

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Elliott's Oyster House

Pier 56

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

The Crab Pot

Pier 57

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Pier 62's Overlook Walk

the new waterfront

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Six Seven

Edgewater Hotel; on the water

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Aqua by El Gaucho

Pier 70

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Anthony's HomePort

Shilshole

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Agua Verde

Portage Bay; kayaks + tacos

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Ivar's Salmon House

Lake Union

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Canlis

Queen Anne; the view since 1950

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Group

Betty

Queen Anne

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Toulouse Petit

Queen Anne; the patio

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Bastille

closed ; use Ballard's Percy's? — CLOSED;
use The Sexton (Ballard)

Smith Tower's Observatory bar

Pioneer Square; 35th floor

\$\$\$

Date night Group

Smith Tower Observatory Bar

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

Kerry Park + a picnic from DeLaurenti

the view, the classic

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group



Bars · 114 places

Bars

A Beard-nominated bar in Belltown, the largest spirits collection in the hemisphere, and the saloons since 1888.

A serious cocktail city since Zig Zag and Rob Roy — Anu Apte is a Beard semifinalist, Roquette too — with saloons since 1888 and a beer culture that gave the country its IPA lineage.

Why these Ranked and recognized first, then institutions, hotel bars, dives, wine, beer. Jules Maes, Central Saloon and J&M for history; Fremont and Holy Mountain for the beer; Le Caviste for the wine.

Ranked & recognized

Roquette

Belltown

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Rob Roy

Belltown

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Anu Apte) \$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Canon

Capitol Hill

JBF Outstanding Bar Program (past nominee)

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Le Caviste

Belltown

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Zig Zag Café

Pike Place; where Murray Stenson worked

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bathtub Gin & Co

Belltown

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Deep Dive

South Lake Union; Renee Erickson

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Cocktail institutions

Needle & Thread

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Tavern Law

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Knee High Stocking Co

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Foreign National

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Sun Liquor

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Rumba

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Herb & Bitter

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Doctor's Office

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bar Vacilando

Capitol Hill

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Life on Mars

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Vito's

First Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Inside Passage

Belltown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Navy Strength

Belltown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

No Anchor

Belltown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

The Backdoor at Roxy's

Fremont

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Hazlewood

Ballard

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Barnacle

Ballard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Essex

Ballard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

ShibShib

Chinatown-ID

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Damn the Weather

Pioneer Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Good Bar

Pioneer Square

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Bar Ferdinand

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Artusi

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Pennyroyal

Sorrento

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Ben Paris

State Hotel

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bookstore Bar

Alexis

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Fireside Room

Sorrento

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bar Melusine

closed

Liberty

Capitol Hill; sushi + cocktails

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Montana

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Tin Lizzie Lounge

Queen Anne; MarQueen Hotel

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Mistral Kitchen

closed

Tomo's bar

White Center

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Georgetown's Flying Squirrel

\$\$

Date night Late night

Hotel & classic bars

The Nest

Thompson

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Mbar

SLU

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Fog Room

Charter

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Frolik

Motif

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Pennyroyal / Fireside Room

Sorrento

\$\$

Date night Late night

Bookstore Bar

Alexis

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Ben Paris

State Hotel

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

The Georgian

Fairmont Olympic

\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Shuckers

Fairmont Olympic; oysters

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Late night

Oliver's Lounge

Mayflower Park; the martini

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Six Seven

Edgewater

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Ace Hotel Seattle

closed

Canlis bar

Queen Anne

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Pink Door bar

Pike Place

\$\$

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Smith Tower Observatory Bar

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

[Historic / dive / neighborhood](#)

Central Saloon

Pioneer Square; 1892

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

J&M Café

Pioneer Square; 1889

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Merchant's Café

Pioneer Square

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Jules Maes

Georgetown; 1888

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Blue Moon Tavern

U District; 1934

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Linda's Tavern

Capitol Hill

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

The Comet

Capitol Hill

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Cha Cha Lounge

Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Unicorn

Capitol Hill

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Shorty's

Belltown

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Hattie's Hat

Ballard

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

King's Hardware

Ballard

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Smoke Shop

Ballard

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Al's Tavern

Wallingford

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Buckaroo Tavern

closed

The Dubliner

Fremont

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Brouwer's Café

Fremont; Belgian beer

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Nickerson Street Saloon

Fremont

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Mecca Café

Queen Anne; since 1930

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

Ozzie's

Queen Anne; karaoke

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

5 Point Café

Belltown; since 1929, 24 hours

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#)

~~The Two Bells?~~

closed ; use [Rendezvous \(Belltown; the Jewelbox Theater\)](#)

Beveridge Place Pub

West Seattle

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

West 5

West Seattle

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Marco Polo Bar & Grill

Georgetown

verify \$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Dynasty Room

Chinatown-ID

new \$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

~~Bush Garden~~

closed (karaoke; relocated?) — ?

[Wine bars](#)

Le Caviste

Belltown

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

L'Oursin

Central District

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Vif

Fremont

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bar Ferdinand

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Artusi

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Light Sleeper

Capitol Hill; wine bar

new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Bottlehouse

Madrona

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Bar Sotto?

closed ; use Pink Salt?

Tinte Cellars

Georgetown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Eight Bells Winery

Ravenna

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Late night

Damn the Weather

Pioneer Square

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Beer

Fremont Brewing

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Stoup

Ballard

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Reuben's Brews

Ballard

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Holy Mountain

Interbay

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Cloudburst

Belltown

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Optimism

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Chuck's Hop Shop

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Machine House

Georgetown

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Georgetown Brewing

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Brouwer's

Fremont

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

The Pine Box

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Rhein Haus

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Fair Isle Brewing

Ballard; saisons

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Urban Family

Interbay

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Ravenna Brewing

\$\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Rooftop / view bars that double as great bars

The Nest

Thompson

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Mbar

SLU

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Deep Dive

SLU

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Westward

Lake Union

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Late night

Canlis

Queen Anne

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Late night



Coffee · 50 places

Coffee shops

Where the American espresso bar was born, from Café Allegro in 1975 to the Roastery.

The American espresso bar was born here — Café Allegro in 1975, Starbucks' first store, Vivace's latte art — and the third-wave rooms carry it on. Victrola and Vivace are the pilgrimages; Milstead is the multi-roaster.

Why these Selected for the cup and the room. The bakeries that double as cafés — Bakery Nouveau, Temple, Sea Wolf, Besalu — are the best mornings in the city.

Victrola

Capitol Hill / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Espresso Vivace

Capitol Hill; David Schomer's temple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Caffè Vita

Capitol Hill / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Analog Coffee

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Anchorhead Coffee

Downtown / Bellevue

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Elm Coffee Roasters

Pioneer Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Zeitgeist

Pioneer Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Monorail Espresso

Downtown; the window since 1980

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Storyville

Pike Place; upstairs

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Ghost Alley Espresso

Pike Place; the gum wall

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Le Panier

Pike Place; French bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Starbucks Reserve Roastery

Capitol Hill; the mothership

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

The original Starbucks

Pike Place; the line, the pilgrimage

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Milstead & Co

Fremont; the multi-roaster

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Lighthouse Roasters

Fremont; since 1993

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Fremont Coffee Company

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Herkimer Coffee

Phinney Ridge / U District

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Zoka

Green Lake / U District

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Café Allegro

U District; since 1975; the first espresso bar in Seattle

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Ballard Coffee Works

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Slate Coffee

Ballard / Pioneer Square

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Caffè Umbria

Pioneer Square / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Olympia Coffee

Capitol Hill / West Seattle

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Boon Boona

Renton / Capitol Hill; East African

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Coffeeholc House

Columbia City; Vietnamese

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Hood Famous Cafe + Bar

Chinatown-ID; Filipino, ube

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Empire Espresso

Columbia City

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Squirrel Chops

Central District; coffee + haircuts

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Cortona Café

Central District

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Tougo Coffee

Central District

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Broadcast Coffee

multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Union Coffee

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Porchlight Coffee & Records

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Ada's Technical Books & Café

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Bakery Nouveau

West Seattle / Capitol Hill / Burien

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Temple Pastries

Central District; Christina Wood

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Sea Wolf Bakers

Fremont

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Coyle's Bakeshop

Greenwood

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Macrina Bakery

Belltown / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Crumble & Flake

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Dahlia Bakery?

closed (Tom Douglas)

Byen Bakeri

Queen Anne; Scandinavian

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Larsen's Bakery

Ballard; Danish since 1974

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Cafe Besalu

Ballard; the croissant

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

The Fat Hen

Ballard

\$ Resy Amex ✓
Sweets Brunch

Portage Bay Cafe

multiple; the pancake bar

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Biscuit Bitch

Belltown / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Top Pot Doughnuts

Capitol Hill / multiple; the library

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

General Porpoise

Capitol Hill / multiple; Erickson's doughnuts

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch

Mighty-O Donuts

Wallingford; vegan

\$ Walk-in
Sweets Brunch



Restaurants · 121 places

Restaurants

No Michelin, so: two Beard finalists, thirteen semifinalists, the oyster counters, the Chinatown-ID institutions, and Canlis since 1950.

Michelin has never rated Seattle, so the map is the James Beard lists — two finalists, thirteen semifinalists — plus the oyster counters, the Chinatown-ID institutions since 1904, and Canlis since 1950.

Why these Grouped by recognition, then the classics and the neighborhoods. The Pham sisters' Pho Bac family is the most-honored restaurant group in the city; Oriental Mart is a James Beard America's Classic in a market stall.

The top of the city (Beard-recognized & the tasting counters)

Canlis

Queen Anne; since 1950

JBF (past) \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Atoma

Wallingford; Johnny Courtney

JBF 2026 finalist RoY 2024 \$\$\$

Tock Amex ✓

Date night

Surrell

Madrona; Aaron Tekulve

JBF 2026 finalist \$\$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Archipelago

Hillman City; Aaron & Amber Verzosa;
Filipino tasting

JBF 2026 semifinalist, Outstanding Chef

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Musang

Beacon Hill; Melissa Miranda

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Homer

Beacon Hill; Logan Cox

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Tock

Amex ✓

Date night

Pancita

Ravenna; Janet Becerra

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Ramie

Capitol Hill

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Date night

Little Beast Ballard

JBF 2026 semifinalist RoY 2025 \$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night Group

The Wayland Mill

Northlake

JBF 2026 semifinalist new \$\$\$

Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Café Suliman

Melrose Market

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$\$ Resy

Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Tomo

White Center; Brady Williams, 2019 JBF
Best Chef Northwest

JBF \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sushi Kashiba

Pike Place; Shiro Kashiba

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Sushi Shiro

\$\$

Casual Date night

Wataru

Ravenna; edomae

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Kisaku

Green Lake

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Off Alley

Columbia City

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Harvest Vine

Madison Valley; Basque

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Altura

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Spinasse

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Lark

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Bateau

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Walrus and the Carpenter

Ballard

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Group

The Whale Wins

Fremont

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Westward

Lake Union

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

JuneBaby

Ravenna

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Cafe Juanita

Kirkland

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

The Herbfarm

Woodinville; the nine courses, the drive

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Passage

Inn at Langley, Whidbey Island; Johnny Spero

new \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

~~Willows Inn~~

closed

Copine

Ballard

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

Eden Hill

Queen Anne

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Date night

~~Art of the Table~~

closed

Mamnoon

Capitol Hill; Levantine

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night

Nue

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Ba Bar

multiple; Vietnamese

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Pho Bac Súp Shop

Chinatown-ID / Rainier; the Pham sisters, JBF Outstanding Restaurateur finalists

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

The Boat

Chinatown-ID; Pho Bac's original

JBF \$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Phocific Standard Time

Chinatown-ID; the bar

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Communion

Central District; Kristi Brown

JBF \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Fat's Chicken and Waffles

Central District

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Ezell's Famous Chicken

Central District; Oprah's

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Marination

multiple; Hawaiian-Korean

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Paseo

Fremont / Ballard; the Caribbean roast pork sandwich

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Un Bien

Ballard; the Paseo family's original

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Salumi

Pioneer Square; Batali's family

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Tat's Deli

Pioneer Square; cheesesteaks

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Il Nido

West Seattle; Alki bathhouse

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

~~La Medusa~~

closed

Tutta Bella

multiple

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Bar del Corso

Beacon Hill

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Delancey

Ballard

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night Group

Dino's Tomato Pie

Capitol Hill; Sicilian square

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Serious Pie

multiple; Tom Douglas

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Lupo

Fremont; pizza

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Moto Pizza

West Seattle; Detroit-style, the wait list

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Post Alley Pizza

Pike Place

\$\$

Casual Date night

Taylor Shellfish

multiple

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Elliott's Oyster House

Pier 56

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Ray's Boathouse

Shilshole

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Ivar's Acres of Clams

Pier 54

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night Group

Pike Place Chowder

the line

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Emmett Watson's Oyster Bar

Pike Place; since 1979

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Matt's in the Market

Pike Place

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Le Pichet

Pike Place

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Café Campagne

Pike Place

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

The Pink Door

Pike Place

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night

Il Bistro

Pike Place; downstairs

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Place Pigalle

Pike Place

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Chan

Pike Place; Korean

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Oriental Mart

Pike Place; the Filipino counter, JBF

America's Classic 2020

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Maneki

Chinatown-ID

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Tai Tung

Chinatown-ID; since 1935; Bruce Lee's booth

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual

Jade Garden

Chinatown-ID; dim sum

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night Group

Harbor City

Chinatown-ID; dim sum

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night Group

Dough Zone

multiple; dumplings

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night Group

Din Tai Fung

multiple; the US's second city

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night Group

Shanghai Garden

Chinatown-ID; barley green noodles

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Mike's Noodle House

Chinatown-ID

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Szechuan Noodle Bowl

Chinatown-ID; dumplings + pancakes

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Hood Famous

Chinatown-ID

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual Date night

Kedai Makan

Capitol Hill; Malaysian

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual Date night

Little Uncle

Capitol Hill; Thai

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Bai Tong

Tukwila / Capitol Hill; Thai

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Thai Tom

U District; the counter

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Kin Len

Fremont; Thai street food

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Lionhead

closed

Monsoon

Capitol Hill / Bellevue; Vietnamese

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

Tamarind Tree

Chinatown-ID; Vietnamese

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Salare

closed

Meskel?

closed ; use Cafe Selam (Central District; Ethiopian)

Delish Ethiopian Cuisine

Central District

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Island Soul

Columbia City

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Geo's Cuban & Creole

Columbia City

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Mezcaleria Oaxaca

Queen Anne / Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

La Carta de Oaxaca

Ballard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

El Camión

trucks / Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Taqueria La Fondita?

\$\$

Casual Date night

Dick's Drive-In

Wallingford / multiple; since 1954

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Red Mill Burgers

Phinney / Interbay

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Li'l Woody's

Capitol Hill / multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Beecher's Handmade Cheese

Pike Place; the mac

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Piroshky Piroshky

Pike Place; the line

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ellenos Greek Yogurt

Pike Place

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Lowell's

Pike Place; the view

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

The Crumpet Shop

Pike Place; since 1976

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Toulouse Petit

Queen Anne; the happy hour

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night Group

How to Cook a Wolf

Queen Anne

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

Betty

Queen Anne

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual Date night

The 5 Spot

Queen Anne

\$\$

Casual Date night

Metropolitan Grill

Downtown; the steak

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

El Gaucho

Belltown

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Daniel's Broiler

Lake Union / Bellevue

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Six Seven

Edgewater

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Palisade

Magnolia

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Chinook's

Fishermen's Terminal

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

Salty's on Alki

West Seattle

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual Date night Group

Marination Ma Kai

West Seattle

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Casual Date night Group

Mashiko

West Seattle; sustainable sushi

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Casual Date night

Bakery Nouveau West Seattle

\$\$

Casual Date night

Husky Deli

West Seattle; ice cream since 1932

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual



Brunch · 50 places

Brunch spots

Portage Bay's toppings bar, Glo's line, dim sum in the ID, and the Ballard croissant.

Portage Bay's toppings bar, the line at Glo's since 1985, Toulouse Petit's Creole, and dim sum at Jade Garden.

Why these Kept to places that consistently top Resy and OpenTable's weekend demand plus the counters you walk into. Temple Pastries is the Beard-nominated pastry stop.

Portage Bay Cafe

multiple; the toppings bar

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Biscuit Bitch

Belltown / multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Oddfellows

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Skillet Diner

Capitol Hill / multiple; the bacon jam

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Glo's

Capitol Hill; the line, since 1985

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Wandering Goose

closed

Tallulah's

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Coastal Kitchen

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Volunteer Park Cafe

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Café Presse

Capitol Hill

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

The Fat Hen

Ballard

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Cafe Besalu

Ballard

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Larsen's

Ballard

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Hattie's Hat

Ballard; the hangover breakfast

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Bastille

closed

Stoneburner brunch

Ballard

\$\$

Brunch

Sawyer brunch

Ballard

\$\$

Brunch

Little Beast Ballard weekend

JBF 2026 \$\$

Brunch

The Whale Wins brunch

Fremont

\$\$

Brunch

Roxy's Diner

Fremont; the deli

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Sea Wolf

Fremont

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Fremont's Hale's?

\$\$

Brunch

Eight Row weekend

Green Lake

\$\$

Brunch

JuneBaby brunch

Ravenna

\$\$

Brunch

Ravenna's Zoka + Bakery?

\$\$

Brunch

Mr. West Cafe Bar

Downtown / U Village

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Lola

Downtown; Tom Douglas

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Brunch

Lowell's

Pike Place

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

The Crumpet Shop

Pike Place

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Le Panier

Pike Place

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Café Campagne brunch

Pike Place

\$\$

Brunch

Toulouse Petit brunch

Queen Anne; the Creole

\$\$

Brunch

The 5 Spot

Queen Anne

\$\$

Brunch

Citizen

Queen Anne; crêpes

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Macrina

Belltown

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

5 Point Café

Belltown; 24 hours

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Salumi lunch

Pioneer Square

\$\$

Brunch

Damn the Weather brunch

Pioneer Square

\$\$

Brunch

Ben Paris brunch

Pioneer Square

\$\$

Brunch

Geraldine's Counter

Columbia City; the French toast

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Island Soul brunch

Columbia City

\$\$

Brunch

Fat's Chicken and Waffles

Central District

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Communion brunch

Central District

\$\$

Brunch

Temple Pastries

Central District

[JBF 2026](#) \$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Easy Street Records Café

West Seattle

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Bakery Nouveau

West Seattle

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch

Marination Ma Kai

West Seattle

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Brunch

Jade Garden dim sum

Chinatown-ID

\$\$

Brunch

Harbor City dim sum

Chinatown-ID

\$\$

Brunch

Hood Famous

Chinatown-ID; the ube

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Brunch



Off-beat · 50 places

Off-beat & only-in-Seattle

Fish throwers, a gum wall, an espresso window since 1980, and Bruce Lee's booth.

The fish throwers and the gum wall, an espresso window since 1980, Bruce Lee's booth at Tai Tung, a sandwich argument in Ballard, and oyster farms an hour south.

Why these Selected for singularity. Oriental Mart is a Beard America's Classic in a Pike Place stall; the Herbfarm is the nine-course pilgrimage; Hama Hama is the oyster saloon on the Hood Canal.

Pike Place Market

the fish throwers, the first Starbucks

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Oriental Mart

Pike Place; JBF America's Classic

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Piroshky Piroshky

the line

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Beecher's

the mac and cheese window

\$ Walk-in

Casual

The Crumpet Shop

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ellenos

the yogurt

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Rachel's Ginger Beer

\$ Walk-in

Casual

The Gum Wall

and Ghost Alley Espresso beside it

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Monorail Espresso

the window since 1980

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Dick's Drive-In

the Deluxe, cash

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ivar's

Pier 54; feed the seagulls, since 1938

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Ezell's

Oprah's chicken

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Paseo / Un Bien

the sandwich, the argument

\$

Casual

Salumi

the line, the culatello

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Tat's

the cheesesteak

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Tai Tung

Bruce Lee's booth, since 1935

\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Maneki

since 1904

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Casual

Uwajimaya

Chinatown-ID; the food hall

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Fuji Bakery

Chinatown-ID

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hood Famous

the ube cheesecake

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Pho Bac Súp Shop

the boat

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual

Bush Garden's karaoke

verify \$

Casual

Jules Maes

1888

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Georgetown Trailer Park Mall

Sundays

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Fremont Sunday Market

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

The Fremont Troll

then Kin Len

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Theo Chocolate factory tour

Fremont

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Ballard Farmers Market

Sunday

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Ballard Locks + Ray's afterward

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Fishermen's Terminal + Chinook's

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Wild Salmon Seafood Market

Fishermen's Terminal

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Mutual Fish

Rainier; the market

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Marination

the truck that became a chain

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

El Camión

the truck

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Tacos Chukis

the adobada, upstairs

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Kedai Makan

Malaysian, the line

\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual

Thai Tom

U District; the counter, cash

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Café Allegro

the first espresso bar, 1975

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Espresso Vivace

the latte art origin

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Starbucks Reserve Roastery

the mothership

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Top Pot

the library of doughnuts

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Husky Deli

West Seattle; ice cream since 1932

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Molly Moon's

the honey lavender

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Frankie & Jo's

vegan

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Salt & Straw Seattle

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Canlis

the valet, the 1950 room

\$\$\$\$ [Tock](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual

The Herbfarm

Woodinville; the nine-course pilgrimage

\$\$\$\$ [Tock](#) [Amex ✓](#)

Casual

Taylor Shellfish farm

Shelton; the drive

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual

Hama Hama Oyster Saloon

Lilliwaup; the Hood Canal

\$ [Walk-in](#)

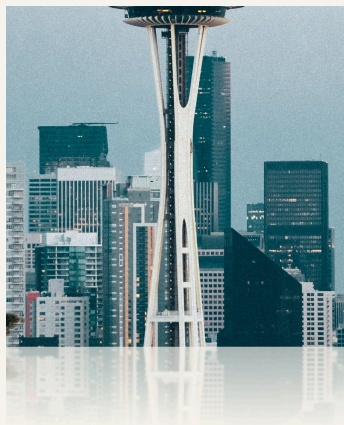
Casual

Beth's Café

Green Lake; the 12-egg omelet

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Casual



Bakeries · 50 places

Bakeries

The twice-baked croissant, a Beard-nominated pastry chef, Scandinavian Ballard, and mochi doughnuts in the ID.

Bakery Nouveau's twice-baked croissant, Temple's Beard-nominated pastry, Ballard's Scandinavian kringle, and mochi doughnuts in the ID.

Why these Chosen on the strength of one signature item each. Three Girls has been in the market since 1912; Larsen's since 1974.

Bakery Nouveau

West Seattle / Capitol Hill / Burien

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Temple Pastries

Central District

JBF 2026 semifinalist \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sea Wolf Bakers

Fremont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Coyle's Bakeshop

Greenwood

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Macrina Bakery

multiple; since 1993

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Crumble & Flake

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Besalu

Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Larsen's Bakery

Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Byen Bakeri

Queen Anne

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Le Panier

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Piroszky Piroszky

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

The Crumpet Shop

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Three Girls Bakery

Pike Place; since 1912

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Grand Central Bakery

Pioneer Square / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Columbia City Bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tall Grass Bakery

Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sunny Honey?

\$

Sweets Brunch

Yummy House Bakery

Chinatown-ID

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Mee Sum Pastry

Pike Place; the hum bow

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hood Famous

Chinatown-ID

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Top Pot Doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

General Porpoise

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Mighty-O

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Daily Dozen Doughnuts

Pike Place; the mini

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Frost Doughnuts

Mill Creek; the drive

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Salmonberry Goods

Ballard

verify \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Deep Sea Sugar & Salt

Georgetown; the cakes

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hello Robin

Capitol Hill; cookies

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hot Cakes

Ballard / Capitol Hill; molten chocolate

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Nuflours

Capitol Hill; gluten-free

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dahlia Bakery

closed

Sugar Bakery & Café

First Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

North Hill Bakery

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Le Rêve

Queen Anne

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hiroki

Green Lake; Japanese-French

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Fresh Flours

Phinney / Beacon Hill; Japanese

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Lazy Cow Bakery

Fremont; vegan

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Raised Doughnuts

Central District

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Dochi

Chinatown-ID; mochi doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Sheng Kee

Bellevue

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Regent Bakery

Redmond / Capitol Hill; Hong Kong cakes

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

La Parisienne

Pioneer Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Belle Epicurean

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafe Hitchcock?

closed ; use Bakery: Hitchcock Deli
(Bainbridge; the ferry)

Blackbird Bakery

Bainbridge Island

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Seattle Bagel Bakery

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Rubinstein Bagels

SLU / Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Zylberschein's

Pinehurst; the deli

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Little Oddfellows

Capitol Hill; Elliott Bay Book Co.

\$ Walk-in

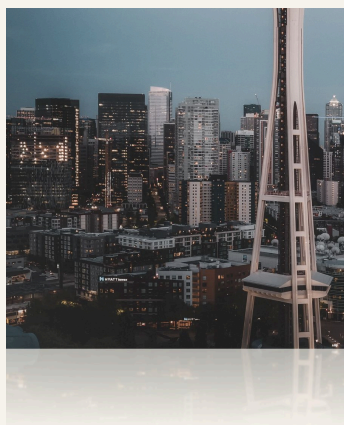
Sweets Brunch

The Flour Box

Beacon Hill; doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch



Dessert • 50 places

Dessert bars & sweets

For after — or instead of — dinner.

Molly Moon's honey lavender, Fran's salted caramel, Theo's factory, Hood Famous' ube cheesecake, and Canlis's finale.

Why these A mix of the destination and the institution. Fran's at the airport is the last stop for a reason.

Molly Moon's

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Frankie & Jo's

Capitol Hill / Ballard; vegan

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Salt & Straw

Capitol Hill / Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Husky Deli

West Seattle

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Full Tilt

multiple; pinball + ice cream

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Fainting Goat Gelato

Wallingford

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Gelatiamo

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bottega Italiana

Pike Place; gelato

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Shug's Soda Fountain

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sweet Alchemy

U District / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Parfait

Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Hood Famous

the ube cheesecake

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Deep Sea Sugar & Salt

Georgetown

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Hot Cakes

Ballard

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Hello Robin

Capitol Hill

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Top Pot

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

General Porpoise

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Mighty-O

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Daily Dozen

\$

Sweets

Dochi

mochi doughnuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Theo Chocolate

Fremont

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Fran's Chocolates

multiple; the salted caramel

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Dilettante

multiple; since 1976

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Intrigue Chocolate

Pioneer Square

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Indi Chocolate

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Ellenos

Pike Place

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Rachel's Ginger Beer

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

The Crumpet Shop

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Piroshky's sweet ones

\$

Sweets

Fuji Bakery's?

\$

Sweets

Don't Yell at Me

Capitol Hill / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sharetea

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Yifang

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Snowy Village

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Meet Fresh

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Beard Papa's

Uwajimaya

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Uwajimaya's bakery counter

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Temple Pastries

JBF 2026 \$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sea Wolf's morning bun

\$

Sweets

Coyle's cruffin

\$

Sweets

Bakery Nouveau's twice-baked almond croissant

\$

Sweets

Besalu's croissant

\$

Sweets

Larsen's kringle

\$

Sweets

Byen's cardamom bun

\$

Sweets

Canlis's dessert

Queen Anne

\$

Sweets

Atoma's dessert

Wallingford

JBF 2026 \$

Sweets

Archipelago's finale

Hillman City

JBF 2026 \$

Sweets

The Herbfarm's finale

Woodinville

\$

Sweets

Sushi Kashiba's tamago

Pike Place

\$

Sweets

Fran's at the airport

SEA; the last stop

\$ Walk-in

Sweets



Scene · 50 places

Notable mentions

Where the room is the point: Canlis, the Nest, the Edgewater, and the tasting counters.

Where the room is the point: Canlis and its valet since 1950, the Nest over the market, the Edgewater on the water, and the tasting counters.

Why these Canlis leads; the hotel bars and the water follow. The Herbfarm and Passage on Whidbey are the drive-and-stay rooms.

Canlis

Queen Anne

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

The Nest

Thompson

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Mbar

SLU

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Deep Dive

SLU

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Westward

Lake Union

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Daniel's Broiler

Lake Union

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Six Seven

Edgewater

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Aqua by El Gaucho

Pier 70

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

El Gaucho

Belltown

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Metropolitan Grill

Downtown

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Bateau

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

The Pink Door

Pike Place

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Matt's in the Market

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Sushi Kashiba

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Il Bistro

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Place Pigalle

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Georgian

Fairmont Olympic

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Shuckers

Fairmont Olympic

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Oliver's

Mayflower Park

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Pennyroyal

Sorrento

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Ben Paris

State Hotel

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Frolik

Motif

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Lola

Downtown; Tom Douglas

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Palace Kitchen

Downtown; Tom Douglas

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Mamnoon

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Spinasse

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Altura

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Lark

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Atoma

Wallingford

\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Group Date night

Surrell

Madrona

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Archipelago

Hillman City

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Tomo

White Center

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

The Walrus and the Carpenter

Ballard

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Whale Wins

Fremont

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Copine

Ballard

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Eden Hill

Queen Anne

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Toulouse Petit

Queen Anne

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Palisade

Magnolia

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Ray's Boathouse

Shilshole

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Salty's on Alki

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Il Nido

West Seattle

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

The Herbfarm

Woodinville

\$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Cafe Juanita

Kirkland

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Passage

Whidbey Island

new \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Ascend Prime

Bellevue; the 31st floor

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Monsoon Bellevue

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Din Tai Fung Bellevue

the original US one

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Soho House?

none; use The Ruins (Queen Anne; members supper club)

\$\$\$

Group Date night

Washington Athletic Club

Downtown; members

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Bar Ferdinand

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night



Nightlife · 50 places

Dance clubs & nightlife

Capitol Hill's rooms, the Crocodile since 1991, the Showbox since 1939.

Capitol Hill's rooms — Q, Kremwerk, Neumos — the Crocodile since 1991, the Showbox since 1939, and the jazz at Dimitriou's.

Why these Venues and clubs together. Re-bar, the Baltic Room and R Place are listed closed; Wildrose is on for being one of the last lesbian bars in the country.

Q Nightclub

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Kremwerk / Timbre Room / Cherry

Denny Triangle; the complex

\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Supernova

SoDo

\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Monkey Loft

SoDo; the rooftop dance floor

\$\$ [SevenRooms](#)

Late night Group

Neumos

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Barboza

below Neumos

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

The Crocodile

Belltown; since 1991

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Showbox

Downtown; since 1939

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Showbox SoDo

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Tractor Tavern

Ballard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Sunset Tavern

Ballard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Conor Byrne

Ballard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

The Royal Room

Columbia City; jazz

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Dimitriou's Jazz Alley

Belltown; since 1979

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

The Triple Door

Downtown; supper club

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Late night Group

Musicquarium

Triple Door's lounge

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Vermillion

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Chop Suey

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

The Vera Project

Seattle Center; all-ages

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Late night Group

Clock-Out Lounge

Beacon Hill

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Late night Group

Substation

Ballard

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Central Saloon

Pioneer Square; live music

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Nectar Lounge

Fremont

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

High Dive

Fremont

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Add-a-Ball

Fremont; pinball

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Unicorn

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Cha Cha Lounge

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Pony

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

The Cuff Complex

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Neighbours

Capitol Hill; since 1983

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

RPlace

closed (relocated?) — ?

Wildrose

Capitol Hill; the lesbian bar since 1984

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Massive

Capitol Hill

new \$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Queer/Bar

Capitol Hill

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Baltic Room

closed

Re-bar

closed

Trinity?

closed

Foundation Nightclub

Belltown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Aston Manor?

closed

Ora Nightclub

Belltown

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Contour?

closed ; use [Rendezvous's Jewelbox](#) (Belltown)

The Rabbit Box

Pike Place; comedy + music

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Bush Garden karaoke

verify \$\$\$

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Rock Box

Capitol Hill; karaoke rooms

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Ozzie's

Queen Anne; karaoke

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Georgetown's 9 Million in Unmarked Bills

\$\$\$

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Jules Maes late

Georgetown

\$\$\$

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Climate Pledge Arena

concerts

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Paramount Theatre

Downtown

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)

Moore Theatre

Belltown; since 1907

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Late night](#) [Group](#)



Itineraries · for a first-time visitor

Just follow this.

Three ready-made food itineraries — one, three and five days — built only from places on this list, so a first-time visitor can eat well without doing the research.

Each plan runs on foot and by subway, one borough a day, with a big dinner every night and a backup for every table that's hard to get. Times are suggestions; the order matters more than the clock.

How to use it Book the starred dinners the morning reservations open, then walk everything else. The gotchas on the last page cover the rest: cash, tickets, tipping, dress codes, and the Amex credit.

Itinerary · One day

One day

Pike Place to Capitol Hill, on foot. Oysters at noon, a Beard finalist at eight.

One day, walkable if you accept the hills. Book one dinner. **Book one thing: dinner at Atoma (Tock) — or the Walrus if it's gone.**

The day

- | | |
|-------|---|
| 8:00 | Café Allegro (University District) or Espresso Vivace (Capitol Hill)
The first espresso bar in Seattle (1975), or the one that invented latte art. Pick one; walk-in. |
| <hr/> | |
| 9:30 | Pike Place Market
Before the crowds: Piroshky's line, the Crumpet Shop, a hum bow at Mee Sum, the fish throwers. Oriental Mart in the arcade for a Filipino breakfast — a James Beard America's Classic in a stall. |
| <hr/> | |
| 12:00 | Emmett Watson's or Taylor Shellfish (Pike Place / Capitol Hill)
A dozen Kumamotos and Shigokus, the Sound's oysters at their source. Walk-in. |
| <hr/> | |
| 2:00 | Capitol Hill
Melrose Market: Café Suliman (Beard Emerging Chef semifinalist) for a late lunch, Temple Pastries for a pastry, Elliott Bay Book Co. |
| <hr/> | |
| 4:00 | Zig Zag Café (the Hillclimb)
Where Murray Stenson made the Last Word famous. Walk-in; then the Nest on the Thompson's roof for the Sound at golden hour. |
| <hr/> | |
| 6:00 | Canon (Capitol Hill)
The largest spirits collection in the Western Hemisphere; order from the book. Walk-in early; the wait builds. |
| <hr/> | |
| 8:00 | Atoma (Wallingford) or The Walrus and the Carpenter (Ballard)
Atoma for Johnny Courtney's snack-sized starters — a 2026 Beard finalist and Restaurant of the Year (Tock); the Walrus for Renee Erickson's oyster bar (walk-in, put your name down at 4 and wander Ballard). Backup: Musang (Filipino; Resy) or Homer (Beacon Hill; Resy). |
| <hr/> | |
| 10:30 | Rob Roy (Belltown)
Anu Apte's bar, a Beard semifinalist for cocktail service. Then Dick's for a Deluxe on the way home, cash, since 1954. |

Three days

Downtown and Capitol Hill, then Ballard and Fremont, then Beacon Hill and the ID. One neighborhood cluster a day.

A long weekend. Day one is the one-day plan; day two goes north across the ship canal; day three goes south. **Book three dinners the day reservations open: Atoma, Canlis, and Archipelago or Surrell.**

Day 1 · Downtown & Capitol Hill

All day **Follow the one-day plan**
Coffee, the market, oysters, Melrose Market, Zig Zag, Canon, Atoma, Rob Roy.

Day 2 · Ballard & Fremont

9:00 **Cafe Besalu (Ballard)**
The croissant Seattle argues about. Walk-in; the line moves. Larsen's for a kringle on the way out.

11:00 **Ballard**
The Locks and the fish ladder, the Sunday market if it's Sunday, Un Bien for the Caribbean roast pork sandwich — the original family, the better sandwich.

1:30 **Fremont**
Theo Chocolate's factory, the Troll, Milstead & Co for the multi-roaster pour-over, Sea Wolf for a morning bun at lunch.

3:30 **Fremont Brewing**
The urban beer garden, a Lush IPA, a pretzel. Then Brouwer's for the Belgian list if it's raining.

6:00 **Westward (Lake Union)**
The fire pit on the water, the Needle across the lake, one drink before dinner. Resy.

8:00 **Canlis (Queen Anne)**
Since 1950 — the valet, the view, the tasting menu. Tock, weeks out; jackets not required but everyone tries. Backup: the Whale Wins (Fremont; Resy) or Copine (Ballard; Resy).

10:30 **Hazlewood (Ballard) or the Backdoor at Roxy's (Fremont)**
Hazlewood is tiny and perfect; the Backdoor is through the diner. Either walks in.

Day 3 • South

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|-------|--|
| 9:30 | Jade Garden or Harbor City (Chinatown-ID)
Dim sum from the carts. Walk-in; arrive before ten on a weekend. |
| 11:30 | Chinatown-ID
Uwajimaya's food hall, Maneki's room since 1904 (look, then book for dinner another time), Hood
Famous for ube cheesecake, Tai Tung for Bruce Lee's booth. |
| 1:30 | Pho Bac Súp Shop (Chinatown-ID)
The Pham sisters' boat — two-time Beard Outstanding Restaurateur finalists — for the pho and the whole story. Walk-in. |
| 3:30 | Beacon Hill
Bar del Corso for a pizza to share, then a look at Musang and Homer's block — both Beard semifinalists, both here. |
| 5:30 | ShibShib (Chinatown-ID)
Ahmed Suliman's new cocktail bar, opened the week of the Beard awards. Walk-in. |
| 7:30 | Archipelago (Hillman City) or Surrell (Madrona)
Archipelago for the Verzosas' Filipino tasting menu — Outstanding Chef semifinalist (Tock, weeks out); Surrell for Aaron Tekulve's counter — the other 2026 finalist (Tock). Backup: Musang (Resy) or Off Alley (8 seats; Tock). |
| 10:00 | The Royal Room (Columbia City)
Jazz, late. Or Clock-Out Lounge on Beacon Hill for the pizza and the bands. |

Five days

The three-day plan, plus a day on the water and a day for the oyster farms and the islands.

Enough time to leave the city: a ferry, an oyster farm on the Hood Canal, and Whidbey Island's new tasting room. **Set alarms for Canlis, Archipelago, Surrell, and — if you're driving north — Passage on Whidbey.**

Days 1–3

All **Follow the three-day plan**
Downtown and Capitol Hill, Ballard and Fremont, the South End.

Day 4 · The water

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|-------|--|
| 9:00 | Portage Bay Cafe (South Lake Union)
The pancake toppings bar. Walk-in; the wait is real. |
| 11:00 | The Bainbridge ferry
Thirty-five minutes across the Sound; the skyline behind you. Blackbird Bakery and Hitchcock Deli in Winslow, then the ferry back at golden hour. |
| 3:00 | West Seattle water taxi
From Pier 50 to Alki: Marination Ma Kai on the dock for a Hawaiian-Korean plate with the skyline across the bay. |
| 5:00 | Alki
Husky Deli for ice cream since 1932, a walk on the beach, Salty's if you want the view with a glass. |
| 7:30 | Il Nido (Alki bathhouse) or Tomo (White Center)
Il Nido for Mike Easton's pasta in a 1930s bathhouse (Resy); Tomo for Brady Williams — Seattle's last Beard winner — and his counter (Tock). Backup: Mashiko for sustainable sushi (Resy). |
| 10:00 | Beveridge Place Pub (West Seattle)
Beer and a board game. Then the water taxi's last run — check the time — or a car. |

Day 5 • Oysters, or the islands

- 9:00 **Drive south — Hood Canal**
Hama Hama Oyster Saloon at Lilliwaup: oysters shucked at the farm, a fire, the canal. Two hours each way; worth it once. Taylor Shellfish's farm store in Shelton on the way back.
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- 1:00 **Or: Whidbey Island**
The Mukilteo ferry, then Passage at the Inn at Langley — Johnny Spero's Pacific Northwest tasting menu, the D.C. star's new room (Tock; stay the night if you can).
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- 5:00 **Back in the city: Mbar (South Lake Union)**
The Needle at sunset from the roof. Resy.
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- 6:30 **Roquette (Belltown)**
A Beard semifinalist for Outstanding Bar, six seats at the counter. Walk-in early.
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- 8:00 **Sushi Kashiba (Pike Place) or Taneda (Capitol Hill)**
Shiro Kashiba's counter at the market (Tock; the walk-in bar seats go at 5:00); Taneda's eight-seat kaiseki (Tock). Alternative: Wataru's edomae counter in Ravenna (Tock).
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- 11:00 **Fran's at the airport, tomorrow**
The salted caramels are the last stop. Tonight: Dick's, cash, one more Deluxe.

Before you go.

The things New Yorkers know and visitors learn the expensive way.

Tock for the counters, Resy for the rooms.

Canlis, Archipelago, Surrell, Atoma, the Herbfarm, Kashiba, Taneda and Wataru sell tickets on Tock, often weeks out. The Walrus doesn't take reservations — put your name down at 4pm and wander Ballard. Resy runs the rest, 30 days out.

The ferries are the transit and the attraction.

Bainbridge from Colman Dock, West Seattle by water taxi from Pier 50, Whidbey from Mukilteo. Walk-on fares are cheap; car lines are not. Check the last sailing before dinner.

Cash at the counters.

Dick's, Thai Tom, Un Bien, Tat's, the market's stalls and most of the ID's bakeries are cash-first. Carry \$60 on the market day.

Tip 20%; the minimum wage is the highest in the country.

Seattle's \$20+ minimum means some restaurants have dropped tipping for a service charge (Canlis, among others) — it's on the menu. Sales tax on meals is 10.35%. Read the bill.

It rains, and the city ignores it.

October to May, most days. Rooftops and beer gardens close or empty; the Nest and Mbar have heaters. Nobody carries an umbrella; a hood is the local uniform. Summer — July to September — is when the city is the best in the country.

Last call is 2am; the light rail runs until 1.

Link light rail connects the airport, the ID, Capitol Hill, the U District and Northgate; buses do the rest. Ballard and Fremont after midnight are a car. The ORCA card is optional — tap a contactless card.

Monday is dark.

Atoma, Archipelago, Surrell, Canlis and most chef rooms close Sunday and/or Monday. The market, the ID and the pho shops run seven days.

The oyster vocabulary.

Kumamoto: small, sweet, from Humboldt Bay. Shigoku: Taylor's tumbled Pacific, deep-cupped. Olympia: the tiny native, coppery. Order a dozen mixed and a Washington white; the Sound's oysters are best from October to April.

Use the Amex credit like a local.

Platinum \$100 per quarter, Gold \$50 twice a year, at any Resy or Tock venue showing the 'Resy Credit eligible' badge. A Canlis ticket on Tock is the easiest use of it.

Anything marked verify, verify.

Seattle lost Bar Melusine, Sitka & Spruce, Salare, Il Corvo, the London Plane and the Willows Inn within a few years. A minute on Resy or Google before you take a ferry.

Coffee: the lineage.

Café Allegro (1975) was the first espresso bar; Starbucks' first store is at 1912 Pike Place (the line is the tourists'); Vivace invented the rosetta; Victrola, Milstead and Analog are where the city drinks now. Ordering a 'tall' anywhere but Starbucks will be noted.

One for the road.

Sea-Tac has a Beecher's, an Ivar's, a Fran's and a Sub Pop store. Buy the caramels; skip the airport chowder.

Notes

Michelin does not publish a Seattle guide, so the James Beard Foundation's 2026 awards are the cross-check. Seattle's finalists were Johnny Courtney of Atoma and Aaron Tekulve of Surrell for Best Chef: Northwest and Pacific — neither won (Portland's Nodoguro did), extending a shutout that dates to Brady Williams's 2019 win at Canlis. The semifinalists were Archipelago (Outstanding Chef), Café Suliman (Emerging Chef), Little Beast Ballard and the Wayland Mill (Best New Restaurant), Temple Pastries (Outstanding Pastry Chef), Le Caviste (Wine), Roquette (Outstanding Bar), Anu Apte of Rob Roy (Cocktail Service), and Musang, Homer, Pancita and Ramie (Best Chef). The Pham sisters of Pho Bac were Outstanding Restaurateur finalists in 2024 and 2025. Seattle Met's Restaurants of the Year — Atoma (2024), Little Beast (2025) — are marked RoY; Oriental Mart holds a James Beard America's Classic.

Occasion chips for Seattle are editorial assignments, by category and price. Tock runs the tasting counters (Canlis, Archipelago, Surrell, the Herbfarm); Resy the neighborhood rooms; the Amex credit works at both.

Photography via Pexels (royalty-free): three photographs, cropped and reused across the twelve sections.

Honestly Speaking — the masthead these guides are published under — is also an independent, unsponsored restaurant review site. The full reviews, with the plate-first criticism the city guides don't have room for, live at honestlyspeaking.xyz. The city guides live at listedeville.com.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listedeville.com.